Disaster Action Team Program

Pocket Guide



October 2024

American Red Cross

Mission Statement

The American Red Cross prevents and alleviates human suffering in the face of emergencies by mobilizing the power of volunteers and the generosity of donors.

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Note: This Pocket Guide is a ready reference, not a definitive manual. For more complete information see *Disaster Action Team Program Standards and Procedures* online at OneSource.

On Scene

Safety Reminders

Safety of the Red Cross workforce is a top priority:

- Do not self-deploy.
- A minimum of two responders, one of whom must be a DAT-SV/MN, is required.
- Do not proceed when driving conditions are unsafe.
- Arrange to meet the team so you arrive together. NEVER be on-scene alone.
- Stay well clear of emergency equipment and fire hoses.
- Never cross emergency barriers or tapes without permission.
- Always follow the instructions of police and fire officials.
- Do not enter burned or damaged buildings.

Meeting the Client

- Remember the “Good Hello” and “Good Goodbye”.
- Listen to your client and be aware of the signs of stress.
- Apply basic Psychological First Aid.

Psychological First Aid Reminders



Detailed Damage Assessment (DDA)

An **essential living space** is a room in a home that:

- Serves as a bedroom, bathroom, kitchen, and/or living room,
- Is regularly occupied or used by one or more members of the household, and
- Requires repair to bring functionality back to the home. For example, kitchens are considered essential if there is no undamaged kitchen in the home.

This table provides notes on how to determine DDA. DAT Responders must NOT enter any buildings. See "*Detailed Damage Assessment for DAT Response Operations"* on OneSource for complete information.

Damage Level	Guidance
Destroyed	Damage to two or more major structural components (roof, walls, foundation, basement walls).
Major	Structural or other significant damage that requires extensive repairs. Including interior and exterior walls, ceilings, etc. **Notes**: Damage is obvious to the structure. Interior damage may only be assessed by an EMA official (Fire Dept.).
Minor	Non-structural damage to residence (includes missing shingles or exterior siding, damage to gutters or soffits, damage to drywall or flooring.
Affected	Damage is considered mostly cosmetic, there may be discoloration to walls. **Notes**: Living areas are intact. There may be damage to porches, garages or outbuildings (non-livable spaces).
No Visible Damage	There is no evidence of damage to the structure and the usable living spaces are intact. Note: Consult with EMA officials regarding interior living spaces not visible from outside.
Uninhabitable	Because of the disaster, client is unable to reside in their home for at least 48 hours due to unsafe infrastructure, lack of safe accessibility, or being identified as not suitable or dangerous to live in. This determination should be made in coordination with local emergency officials.

What is a Household?

Each case in RC Care should include all members of a pre-disaster household who plan to recover together.

- A household consists of residents of the home, whatever their relationship, who lived together before the disaster and share basic expenses after the disaster, as stated by the primary client.
- Housemates who plan to recover *separately* after the disaster should be assisted in *separate* cases, each with a separate primary client, assistance, and follow-up.
- If visitors cannot return home in the next day or two, assess their need for financial assistance. Visitors should be included as part of the household if they are recovering together or require a separate case if they are recovering separately.
- Household animals should be documented per the Client Intake tool. Do not group animals (e.g. “two dogs”) List each animal separately.



Determining Client Eligibility

Resource and Referral Cases: When the damage to the home does not qualify the client for Immediate Financial Assistance, a Resource and Referral case should be completed whenever the client requests Red Cross assistance.

- The client may be offered blankets, comfort kits, and other amenities on-scene as appropriate.
- Referrals for Individual Disaster Care may be made.
- Refer the case to Disaster Casework for follow-up.

Financial Assistance Cases: cases eligible for financial assistance due to Destroyed, Major, or Uninhabitable damage classifications.

To determine if the client qualifies for Immediate Assistance, you must:

- Confirm the client's identity.
- Confirm the client's residency.
- Complete the Detailed Damage Assessment (DDA).

Identification and Address	Identification Only	Address Only
*Driver's License *State Issued ID *Consular ID (Some Cases)	*Passport *US Permanent Resident *Other Government ID	*Rental Agreement *Rental Receipt *Utility Bill *Mortgage Statement *Bank Statement *Vehicle Registration *Vehicle Insurance

- Documents to confirm identity must include the client's name, date of birth, and a photo.
- Documents used to confirm address must be current or dated within 60 days of the event and must be in the name of the primary client.

Immediate Assistance

- Eligibility
  - Client must pass ID and Address Confirmations.
  - Detailed Damage Assessment must be: Destroyed, Major, or Uninhabitable.
  - The amount of assistance is based on the size of the household.
- Payment Methods:
  - Electronic Funds Transfer (EFT):
    - Preferred method.
    - Client gets a text message or email from Red Cross and must establish identity by answering questions.
    - Funds can transfer via Zelle, PayPal, Mastercard Send to client's debit card, or Walmart Direct2Cash.
  - Client Assistance Card (CAC):
    - Issued on a prepaid debit card and handed to client in sealed envelope.
    - PIN is enclosed in envelope.
    - Only the client may open the envelope.
    - Supervisors must, and service associates may, carry and account for CACs.
    - DAT Specialists may not carry CACs.

Flags for Individual Disaster Care

- Disaster Health Services:
  - Fatalities
  - Hospitalization / Injuries
  - Loss of medication, glasses, or durable medical equipment
  - Functional and access needs
- Disaster Mental Health:
  - Fatalities
  - Hospitalization / injuries
  - Loss or death of household animals
  - Inability to care for self or children
  - Disorientation / confusion
  - Separation from family or caregiver
  - Significant emotional distress
  - Multiple stressors and limited or no support system
- Disaster Spiritual Care:
  - Fatalities
  - Hospitalization / injuries
  - Loss or death of household animals
  - Significant emotional distress
  - Request for prayer or spiritual support
  - Loss or damage to spiritual items

Scaling Up the Response

The DAT Supervisor on scene should consult the Regional Leadership On-Call (RLOC) for guidance when any uncertainty exists. RLOC must be contacted when:

- A Death has occurred
- Multiple significant injuries have occurred
- A Red Cross worker has been injured
- A Red Cross facility has been damaged
- A significant community evacuation has occurred
- A shelter opening is contemplated or requested
- The incident has significant media coverage
- The total cost of the event is expected to exceed $10,000

Additional escalation triggers may be determined by each Region.

DO NOT initiate casework intake in these cases until further guidance is received.



Wrapping Up

Avoid these Common Mistakes

- If no documentation is available, you may confirm identity and/or residence by using a fire official, emergency management official, neighbor, or relative, BUT you must include the name (or badge number) and phone number of that person in RC Care.
- Landlords, neighbors, and relatives can only be used to confirm identity and residence, and only on an in-person response.
- A disaster-affected client must not serve as the source of ID or address confirmation for another client affected by the same disaster
- When using Fire Department/EMA/other emergency response officials, relatives, neighbors, or landlords for ID/address confirmations, you must speak with them in person or on video to obtain that confirmation. A phone call is not sufficient. You and the person serving as the source of ID/address confirmation must also be face to face with the client (either in person or on video).
- To confirm ID/Address using documents, you must personally look at the documents, in person or on video. Do not text or email documents.

Unless using the document capture feature of RC Care, never take pictures of client documents.

- At a multi-family event, RC Care will create an event number for the first client. Additional client cases should be attached to that event. Do not create new events for each client for a single disaster.
- The smell of smoke, even a strong smell, is not structural damage and will not by itself make the residence uninhabitable. If the client claims to have a pre-existing medical condition, such as asthma, refer the matter to Disaster Health Services for advice.

- If the degree of damage does not meet any of the criteria for Immediate Financial Assistance, the client may still receive Red Cross help. You should open a Resource and Referral case (see page 6). Such clients are eligible for DMH, DHS and DSC support, which may include appropriate financial assistance.

Dealing with News Media

As a DAT responder, when you are on-scene you are the face of the Red Cross for the people we serve, the public, our donors, and the local media.

If you are approached by the media, greet them politely and find out what news outlet they represent. You should refer the media to the DAT Supervisor/Manager who may need to contact Public Affairs.

If necessary, you may:

- Say that you are a volunteer for the Red Cross and the Red Cross is there to assist people affected by the incident.
- Be honest. Never say, “No comment.” If you cannot answer a question, say so, and explain why.
- Keep it simple. Don't use acronyms, jargon, or complicated Red Cross terminology.
- Only talk about the things you know.

Things to avoid:

- Speaking for other agencies
- Giving your opinion
- Talking about clients or what happened to them.
- Providing any details about the incident or speculating as to its cause.
- Using Red Cross jargon (DAT, ERV, DHS, etc.)
- Saying “no comment.” Instead try “I don’t have that information”.
- Providing any information about clients.

Who to call for assistance

- Regional Leadership On Call (RLOC):
  - Case escalation – see page 10
  - For tactical and programatic questions relating to the response

- DAT Duty Officer;
  - For additional resources such as IDC or for canteening requests

- Regional Application Specialist Team (RAST):
  - RC Care access requests
  - Questions about training
  - Sharing and capturing best practices
  - How to conduct client intake in RC Care

- IT Helpdesk (888-778-7762):
  - Reactivation of RC Care Account 24/7
  - System issues, Log-in or password resets
  - RC Care system is unavailable
  - Degraded system performance
  - Unexpected system behavior or error messages

- RC Care Hotline (833-583-3115)
  - Case Creation (When DAT lacks internet connectivity)
  - Issue resolution related to DAT Case (payment issues or correcting case information)

- Login to RC Care:
  - https://rccare.my.site.com/rccare

Language Line

SPOKEN LANGUAGE REMOTE PHONE INTERPRETING

- Call 1-866-874-3972.
- Provide the six-digit client ID number for your home Division.
- Your Division ID is: _____
- If deployed, use the division name where the DRO is located
- Select the language you need:
  - Press **1** for Spanish.
  - Press **2** for all other languages and state the name of the language you need.
  - Press **0** for agent assistance if you do not know the language.

SIGN LANGUAGE VIDEO REMOTE INTERPRETING

1. Install the **LanguageLine Insight** mobile app (iOS or Android)
2. Enter Authentication Code **TY4XY3G48Q**
3. Name the device using your home Division (e.g. “North Central”)
4. Select **Activate Device**
5. Select **American Sign Language**
6. Select **American Sign Language Video** to begin the call

NOTE: Video interpretation services are only approved for ASL use

NOTES